Dupuy 468

Contents: A German princely league would admit new members by majority consent, promise pensions, and later bring in the French king.

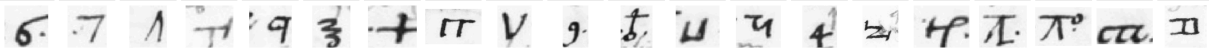
2/3 pages transcribed; 1 more in part; 2/2 cipher pages deciphered

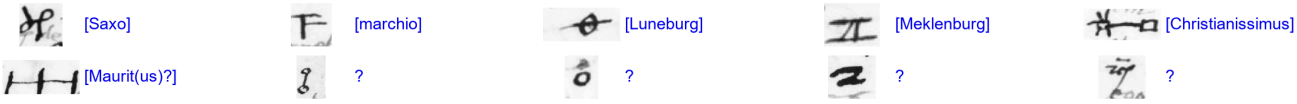
Ciphertext-only: No
Sender: Ernestus dux and Joachimus; probably Ernst of Brunswick-Lüneburg and Joachim von Maltzan
Recipient: Francis I, King of France
Year: Eve of Saint Paul, at five in the morning; no year. Context suggests c.1518–1520;1519 remains plausible.
Key: 30 symbols, 20 letter signs, 6 in nomenclature, 3 nulls?, 1 unidentified
Ciphertext: 684 elements, 660 identified (96.5%)

- **Interlinear plaintext:** Interlinear decipherment accompanies most cipher runs on f28r–v,PDF65–66/Gallica63–64.

Gallica Selected letter, f28r–f29r

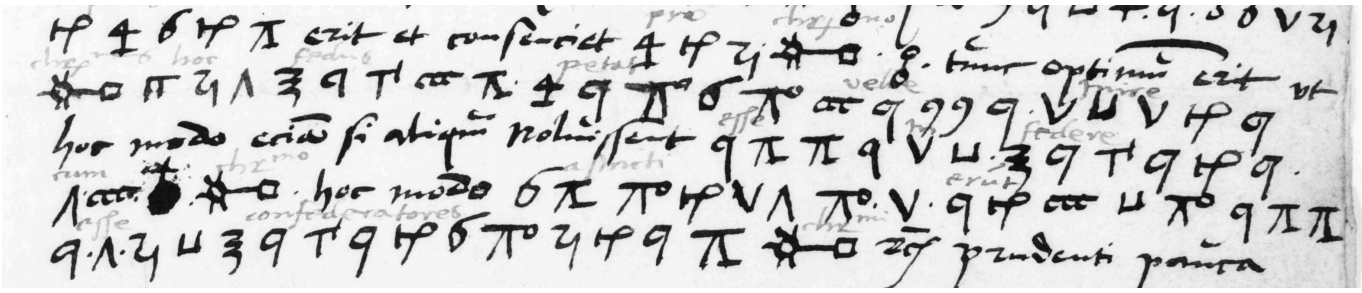
BnF Dupuy 468
Reconstructed by George Lasry with AI - Updated 09/10/2026

a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	l	m	n	o	p	q	r	s	t	u/v	x	y	z
																					



Excerpt and Translation

Excerpt



f28r, final four cipher lines

> Tunc optimum erit ut **christianissimus hoc fedus petat velle inire**; hoc modo etiam si aliquando noluissent **esse in federe cu**[m] **christianissimo**, hoc modo **astricti erunt esse confederatores christianissimi.**

Translation

Then it will be best for the Most Christian King to ask to join this alliance. In this way, even if some had not wished to ally themselves with him, they will be bound to become his allies.

Readable text

Dupuy 468

f28r

Invictissime potentissime ac christianissime Rex ac domine domine observandissime. Post humilimam atque humilimam commendationem Mti vestre certiorem reddimus nos ambos salvos ac fortunatos venisse **in opidum Cerbest et ibi erant simul Maurit(us)**? **Saxo marchio dux de Luneburg** ambo **duces de Meklenburg et multi alii** [?] **ego filius ducis de Luneburg** tractatum cum patre meo ad partem et **ego Iochin**? **ut proposui marchioni conmiss**[i]**onem meam** In presentia **ducis de Luneburg** unius? de **Meklenburg** et consortii mei, quia **marchioni** sic placuit, conclusio hec est: **marchio cum auxilio ducis de Luneburg** [?] **et** prefati **ducis de Meklenburg** faciet totis viribus ut **fedus concludatur** quam? cito? fuerit possibile, est [?] ipsis? omnibus melius et utilius pro **christianissimo** videtur, ut primo de **christianissimo** nulla fiat mentio, sed inter **eos et qui inter Germanie principes attrahi possunt fiat fedus** [?] **et unus articulu**[s] **inponetur ut nullus alius in istud fedus acceptaretur nisi maiore parte confederatorum consen**[t]**iente et quemcumque maior pars admitteret** aut q[?]? **consentiret ut minor pars admitteret et consentire teneretur.** Deinde poterit paulatim **tractari cum his qui non** dum habent speciale **fedus aut** singulare **amiciciam cum christianissimo ut speciale fedus fiat** aut amicitia, ac tandem ubi **securum sit** quod **longe maior pars** erit et conservet? **pro christianissimo** tunc optimum erit ut **christianissimus hoc fedus petat velle inire** hoc modo etiam si aliquando noluissent **esse in federe cu**[m] **christianissimo** hoc modo **astricti erunt esse confederatores christianissimi**. Vestre prudentie [?]?

f28v

Nos omnino speramus quod fiet ut cito faciemus **maiorem ligam et confederacionem in favorem christianissimi**, quod fit **in tota Germania** . Sed oportet omnino ut **marchio dux de Luneburg** omnino consultum ut aliquis etiam nobis necesse et consultavidetur ut hiis qui non habent **a christianissimo pensionem ipsis promittatur** . Et videtur **marchio** consultum ut conso[r]te? nobis **gallum christianissimus** non mittat principem? pro posse? sed nobis [?] duobus autoritatem det p[ri]vatis? **principibus** promittendi donec quando **fedus inter eos factum sit** ac temporibus erit ut **christianissimus ingrediatur**. Deinde **christianissimus** poterit mittere ad placitum cuius? [?]

De ista materia [?] Nos minore suspicione faciemus [?] Majestas vestra intelliget haec ex litteris quas ego conscripsi ad dominum Cancellarium et de addenda? inclusa [?] majestati vestre [?] significavimus, restat nos majestati vestre humilime atque humiliter commendamus quam optimus maximus felicissime conservat?

Data in vigilia sancti Pauli in mane hora quinta.

f29r

Humillimi servitores,

Ernestus dux etc.

Joachimus etc.